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Mission Mutual

Jude

Jude - Introduction

Part 1: General introduction

Outline of Jude

1. Introduction (1:1-2)
2. Warning against false teachers (1:3-4)
3. Comparison of false teachers to Old Testament examples (1:5-16)
4. Exhortation to live godly lives in response (1:17-23)
5. Praises to God (1:24-25)

Who wrote the book of Jude?

The author identified himself as Jude, the brother of James. Both Jude and James were half-brothers of Jesus. It is unknown whether this letter was intended for a specific church.

What is the book of Jude about?

Jude wrote this letter to warn believers against false teachers. Jude often referred to the Old Testament. This may suggest that Jude was writing to a Jewish Christian audience. This letter and 2 Peter have similar content. They both speak about angels, Sodom and Gomorrah, and false teachers.

How should the title of this book be translated?

Translators may choose to call this book by its traditional title, “Jude.” Or they may choose a clearer title, such as “The Letter from Jude” or “The Letter Jude Wrote.” (See: How to Translate Names)

Part 2: Important religious and cultural concepts

Who were the people Jude spoke against?

It is possible that the people Jude spoke against were those who would later become known as Gnostics. These teachers distorted the teachings of Scripture for their own gain. They lived in immoral ways and taught others to do the same.

Part 3: Important translation issues

Singular and plural “you”

In this book, the word “I” refers to Jude. Also, the word “you” is always plural and refers to Jude’s audience. (See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’ and Forms of You)

What are the major issues in the text of the Book of 2 Peter?

For the following verse, there are differences between some of the ancient manuscripts. The ULT text follows the reading that most scholars consider to be original

and puts the other reading in a footnote. If a translation of the Bible exists in the language of wider communication in the region, translators may want to consider using the reading found in that version. If not, translators are advised to follow the reading in the ULT. * “that Jesus, having saved a people out of the land of Egypt” (1:5). Some ancient manuscripts have, “that the Lord, having saved a people out of the land of Egypt.”

(See: Textual Variants)

Jude 1:1 (#3)

Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ δοῦλος, ἀδελφὸς δὲ Ἰακώβου

“a servant of Jesus Christ and a brother of James”

These phrases give further information about Jude. He describes himself as being both **a servant of Jesus Christ** and **a brother of James**. This distinguishes him from the two other men named Jude in the New Testament, which English translations usually distinguish from Jude by translating their names as “Judas”.

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

Jude 1:1 (#2)

Ἰούδας

“Jude”

Jude is the name of a man, the brother of James. See the information about him in Part 1 of the Introduction to Jude.

See: How to Translate Names

Jude 1:1 (#8)

Θεῷ Πατρὶ

“God the Father”

Father is an important title for God.

See: Translating Son and Father

Jude 1:1 (#4)

ἀδελφὸς & Ἰακώβου

“a brother of James”

James and Jude were half brothers of Jesus. Joseph was their physical father, but he was not the physical father of Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this relationship explicitly. Alternate translation: [a brother of James, both being half brothers of Jesus]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Jude 1:1 (#9)

Ἰησοῦ Χριστῷ τετηρημένοις κλητοῖς

“kept {and} called in Jesus Christ”

If your language does not use the passive form **kept {and} called**, you could express this with an active form. Alternate translation: [those whom Jesus Christ keeps and calls]

See: Active or Passive

Jude 1:1 (#1)

Ἰούδας

“Jude”

In this culture, letter writers would give their own names first, and they would refer to themselves in the third person. If that would be confusing in your language, you could use the first person. If your language has a particular way of introducing the author of a letter, you could also use that. Alternate translation: [I, Jude, am writing this letter] or [From Jude]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Jude 1:1 (#6)

κλητοῖς

“and} called”

That these people have been **called** implies that God has called and saved them. Alternate translation: [and whom God has called and saved]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Jude 1:1 (#5)

τοῖς

“to the ones”

In this culture, after giving their own names, letter writers would then say to whom they were writing, naming those people in the third person. If that would be confusing in your language, you could use the second person. Alternate translation: [to you who are]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Jude 1:1 (#7)

ἐν Θεῷ Πατρὶ ἡγαπημένοις

“loved in God the Father”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express this with an active form. Alternate translation: [whom God the Father loves]

See: Active or Passive

Jude 1:2 (#4)

ὕμῃν

“to you”

The word **you** in this letter refers to the Christians to whom Jude was writing and is always plural.

See: Forms of You

Jude 1:2 (#3)

ἐλεος & καὶ εἰρήνη, καὶ ἀγάπη πληθυνθείη

“May mercy and peace and love be multiplied”

Jude speaks of **mercy and peace and love** as if they were objects that could increase in size or numbers. If this is confusing in your language, you can use a different metaphor that means that these things will increase, or use plain language. Alternate translation: [May God increase his mercy and peace and love]

See: Metaphor

Jude 1:2 (#2)

ἐλεος ὑμῖν, καὶ εἰρήνη, καὶ ἀγάπη πληθυνθείη

“May mercy and peace and love be multiplied to you”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the abstract nouns **mercy, peace, and love** by stating the ideas behind them with equivalent expressions. Alternate translation: [May God multiply his merciful acts to you and give you a more peaceful spirit and love you more and more]

See: Abstract Nouns

Jude 1:2 (#1)

ἐλεος ὑμῖν, καὶ εἰρήνη, καὶ ἀγάπη πληθυνθείη

“May mercy and peace and love be multiplied to you”

In this culture, letter writers would offer a good wish for the recipient before introducing the main business of the letter. Use a form in your language that makes it clear that this is a greeting and blessing. Alternate translation: [May God increase his mercy and peace and love to you]

See: Blessings

Jude 1:3 (#5)

ἡμῶν

“our”

Here, **our** refers to Jude and his audience, fellow believers.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Jude 1:3 (#10)

ἅπαξ

“once for all”

Here, **once for all** expresses the idea of something that was done only once and never again. The meaning of **for all** is “for all time.” It does not mean “for the sake of all people.”

Jude 1:3 (#1)

ἀγαπητοί

“Beloved ones”

Beloved ones refers here to those to whom Jude is writing; it can be extended to all believers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this term explicitly. Alternate translation: [Beloved fellow believers]

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Jude 1:3 (#8)

παρακαλῶν ἐπαγωνίζεσθαι τῇ & πίστει

“exhorting to contend for the faith”

Jude is leaving out the word “you” that a sentence would need in many languages in order to be complete. This word can be supplied from the previous clause. Alternate translation: [exhorting you to contend for the faith]

See: Ellipsis

Jude 1:3 (#2)

πᾶσαν σπουδὴν ποιούμενος γράφειν ὑμῖν

“making every effort to write to you”

This clause could refer to: (1) that fact that Jude had intended to write about something different than this letter is about. Alternate translation: [although making every effort to write to you]; (2) the time when Jude was writing. Alternate translation: [when making every effort to write to you]

Jude 1:3 (#4)

περὶ τῆς κοινῆς ἡμῶν σωτηρίας

“about our common salvation”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **salvation** with a verbal phrase. Alternate translation: [about how God saved us all together]

See: Abstract Nouns

Jude 1:3 (#7)

παρακαλῶν ἐπαγωνίζεσθαι τῇ & πίστει

“exhorting to contend for the faith”

This is a purpose clause. Jude is stating the purpose for which he has written the letter. In your translation, follow the conventions of your language for purpose clauses. Alternate translation (without a comma preceding): [in order to exhort you to contend for the faith]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Jude 1:3 (#9)

τῇ ἅπαξ παραδοθείσῃ τοῖς ἁγίοις πίστει

“for the faith delivered once for all to the saints”

If your language does not use the passive form **delivered**, you state who did the action. Alternate translation: [for the faith that God delivered once for all to the saints]

See: Active or Passive

Jude 1:3 (#6)

ἀνάγκην ἔσχον γράψαι

“I have a necessity to write”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **necessity** with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [I needed to write]

See: Abstract Nouns

Jude 1:3 (#3)

περὶ τῆς κοινῆς ἡμῶν σωτηρίας

“about our common salvation”

Alternate translation: [concerning the salvation we share]

Jude 1:4 (#8)

ἡμῶν & ἡμῶν

“our & our”

Both occurrences of **our** in this verse refer to all believers.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Jude 1:4 (#12)

τὸν μόνον Δεσπότην καὶ Κύριον ἡμῶν

“our only Master and Lord”

Here, **Lord** means “the person who is lord over us” or “the person who rules over us.” The conjunction **and** indicates that **our** also applies back to **only Master**, meaning “the person who owns us.” Alternate translation: [the only person who owns us and rules over us]

See: Possession

Jude 1:4 (#7)

τὴν τοῦ Θεοῦ ἡμῶν χάριτα μετατιθέντες εἰς ἁσέλγειαν

“changing the grace of our God into licentiousness”

Here, God’s **grace** is spoken of as if it were a thing that could be changed into something sinful. If this would be confusing in your language, you could translate this plainly. The false teachers were teaching that believers could do sexually immoral acts because God’s grace allowed it. Paul addressed this kind of false teaching when he wrote in Romans 6:1-2a: “Should we continue in sin so that grace may abound? May it never be!” Alternate translation: [teaching that God’s grace permits licentiousness]

See: Metaphor

Jude 1:4 (#6)

ἄσεβεῖς

“ungodly ones”

Here, **ungodly ones** refers to the “certain men” mentioned at the beginning of the verse. They are the false teachers Jude is warning his readers about. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this term explicitly. Alternate translation: [ungodly false teachers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Jude 1:4 (#1)

γάρ

“For”

Here, **For** indicates that Jude is giving a reason for why he said in the previous verse that he wants his readers

to “contend for the faith.” Alternate translation: [I want you do to this because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Jude 1:4 (#3)

Παρεισέδυσαν γάρ τινες ἄνθρωποι

“For certain men have entered secretly”

In this phrase, Jude is leaving out words from this sentence that it would need in many languages in order to be complete. If this phrase is required in your language, it can be supplied from verse 12. Alternate translation: [For certain men have entered secretly into your love feasts] or [For certain men have entered secretly into your gatherings]

See: Ellipsis

Jude 1:4 (#4)

οἱ πάλαι προγεγραμμένοι εἰς τοῦτο τὸ κρίμα

“the ones long ago having been designated beforehand for this condemnation”

If your language does not use this passive form **having been designated**, you could state who did the action. Alternate translation: [men whom God long ago designated beforehand for this condemnation]

See: Active or Passive

Jude 1:4 (#9)

τὴν τοῦ Θεοῦ ἡμῶν χάριτα

“the grace of our God”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **grace** with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [the kind acts of our God]

See: Abstract Nouns

Jude 1:4 (#5)

εἰς τοῦτο τὸ κρίμα

“for this condemnation”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **condemnation** with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [to be condemned]

See: Abstract Nouns

Jude 1:4 (#10)

εἰς ἁσέλγειαν

“into licentiousness”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **licentiousness** with an adjective phrase. Alternate translation: [into licentious behavior]

See: Abstract Nouns

Jude 1:4 (#2)

παρεισέδυσαν γάρ τινες ἄνθρωποι

“For certain men have entered secretly”

Alternate translation: [For some men have snuck in unnoticed] or [For some men have come in without drawing attention to themselves]

Jude 1:4 (#11)

τὸν μόνον Δεσπότην καὶ Κύριον ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦν Χριστόν, ἀρνούμενοι

“denying our only Master and Lord, Jesus Christ”

Alternate translation: [teaching that Jesus Christ is not our Master and Lord]

Jude 1:5 (#3)

ὅτι Ἰησοῦς

“that Jesus”

Here some ancient manuscripts have, “that the Lord.” See the discussion of textual issues at the end of the Introduction to Jude to decide which phrase to use in your translation.

See: Textual Variants

Jude 1:5 (#4)

λαὸν ἐκ γῆς Αἰγύπτου σώσας

“having saved a people out of the land of Egypt”

This could mean that: (1) Jude is indicating the timing of the event described in this clause, in which case the timing is made clear by the occurrence of “afterward” in the next clause. (2) Jude is making a contrast between what Jesus did in this clause and what he did in the next. Alternate translation: [although he saved a people out of the land of Egypt]

Jude 1:5 (#2)

πάντα

“all things”

Here, **all things** refers specifically to all the information of which Jude is going to remind his readers.

It does not mean everything there is to know about God or everything in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this phrase explicitly. Alternate translation: [all these things of which I am reminding you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Jude 1:5 (#5)

λαὸν ἐκ γῆς Αἰγύπτου σώσας

“having saved a people out of the land of Egypt”

If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state explicitly who the people were that he **saved**. Alternate translation: [having saved the people of Israel out of the land of Egypt] or [having saved the Israelites out of the land of Egypt]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Jude 1:5 (#1)

ὑπομνησαι & ὑμᾶς βούλομαι, εἰδότας ὑμᾶς ἅπασι πάντα

“I want to remind you, you knowing all things once for all”

If it would be natural in your language, you could reverse the order of the first two clauses. Alternate translation: [you knowing all things once for all, I want to remind you]

See: Information Structure

Jude 1:6 (#5)

ὑπὸ ζόφον

“under darkness”

Here, **darkness** is a metonym which represents the place of the dead or hell. Alternate translation: [in the utter darkness of hell]

See: Metonymy

Jude 1:6 (#3)

δεσμοῖς αἰδίοις ὑπὸ ζόφον τετήρηκεν

“he has kept in eternal chains, under darkness”

Here, **he** refers to God. If it would be helpful for your readers, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [God has kept in eternal chains, under darkness]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Jude 1:6 (#4)

δεσμοῖς αἰδίοις & τετήρηκεν

“he has kept in eternal chains”

Here, **kept in eternal chains** refers to imprisonment that lasts forever. If it would be helpful in your language, you could include the idea of imprisonment in your translation. Alternate translation: [God has imprisoned for eternity]

Jude 1:6 (#7)

εἰς κρίσιν μεγάλης ἡμέρας

“for judgment of the great day”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **judgment** with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [for the great day when God judges]

See: Abstract Nouns

Jude 1:6 (#2)

τὴν ἑαυτῶν ἀρχὴν

“their own domain”

The word translated as **domain** refers to one’s sphere of influence or the place where one has authority. Alternate translation: [their proper area of influence] or [their own place of authority]

See: Translate Unknowns

Jude 1:6 (#6)

εἰς κρίσιν μεγάλης ἡμέρας

“for judgment of the great day”

This phrase gives the purpose or goal for which the angels have been imprisoned. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of the judgment of the great day]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Jude 1:6 (#8)

μεγάλης ἡμέρας

“of the great day”

Here, **the great day** refers to “the day of the Lord,” which is the time when God judges everyone, and Jesus returns to earth. (See: [[rc://*/tw/dict/bible/kt/dayofthelord]]) If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the great day of the Lord]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Jude 1:6 (#1)

τοὺς μὴ τηρήσαντας τὴν ἑαυτῶν ἀρχὴν

“not having kept their own domain”

Jude uses this phrase to distinguish the **angels** who were kept by God for judgment from those who were not.

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

Jude 1:7 (#4)

καὶ ἀπελθοῦσαι ὀπίσω σαρκὸς ἐτέρας

“and having gone after other flesh”

Here Jude uses the phrase **having gone after** to refer to actively engaging in an improper activity instead of a proper one. This expression is frequently used in the Bible to describe people worshiping false gods or engaging in sexual immorality. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this phrase literally. Alternate translation: [and habitually engaging in sexual immorality with other flesh]

See: Metaphor

Jude 1:7 (#2)

τὸν ὅμοιον τρόπον τοῦτοις

“in the same manner {as} these”

Here, **these** refers to the angels mentioned in the previous verse. The sexual sins of Sodom and Gomorrah were the result of the same kind of rebellion as the angels’ evil ways. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this phrase explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the same manner as these wicked angels]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Jude 1:7 (#1)

Σόδομα καὶ Γόμορρα, καὶ αἱ περὶ αὐτὰς πόλεις

“Sodom and Gomorrah and the cities around them”

Here, **Sodom**, **Gomorrah**, and **cities** all refer to the people who lived in those cities. Alternate translation: [the people in the region of Sodom and Gomorrah]

See: Metonymy

Jude 1:7 (#3)

ἐκπορνεύσασαι

“having committed sexual immorality”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **sexual immortality** with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [having committed sexually immoral acts]

See: Abstract Nouns

Jude 1:7 (#5)

σαρκὸς ἑτέρας

“other flesh”

Here, **other flesh** could refer to: (1) the sexual immorality mentioned in the previous clause. Alternate translation: [improper sexual relations]; (2) flesh of a different species, in this case referring to the angels with whom the people of Sodom and Gomorrah want to have sexual relations. Alternate translation: [flesh of a different type]

Jude 1:7 (#6)

πρόκεινται δεῖγμα

“are being displayed {as} an example”

The destruction of the people of Sodom and Gomorrah is an **example** of what happens to people who reject God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this phrase explicitly. Alternate translation: [are being displayed as an example of those who reject God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Jude 1:7 (#7)

πυρὸς αἰωνίου δίκην ὑπέχουσαι

“suffering punishment of eternal fire”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **punishment** with a verbal phrase. Alternate translation: [suffering when God punished them with eternal fire]

See: Abstract Nouns

Jude 1:8 (#3)

σάρκα μὲν μιαίνουσιν

“indeed defile the flesh”

Here, **flesh** refers to the bodies of these false teachers. Paul agrees with this idea when he says in 1 Corinthians 6:18 that sexual immorality is sin against one’s own body. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this idea explicitly. Alternate translation: [defile their bodies]

See: Metonymy

Jude 1:8 (#1)

ὁμοίως

“in the same way”

Here, **in the same way** refers back to the sexual immorality of the people of Sodom and Gomorrah referred to in the previous verse, and possibly the improper behavior of the wicked angels referred to in verse 6. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this connection explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the same way as these sexually immoral ones]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Jude 1:8 (#2)

οὗτοι ἐνυπνιαζόμενοι

“these, dreaming”

Here, **these** refers to the false teachers introduced in verse 4. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this phrase explicitly. Alternate translation: [these false teachers who dream]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Jude 1:8 (#4)

κυριότητα

“lordship”

Here, **lordship** could refer to: (1) the lordship of Jesus. Alternate translation: [the ruling authority of Jesus]; (2) the lordship of God. Alternate translation: [the ruling authority of God]

Jude 1:8 (#5)

κυριότητα & ἀθετοῦσιν

“reject lordship”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **lordship** with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [reject what Jesus commands] or [reject what God commands]

See: Abstract Nouns

Jude 1:8 (#6)

δόξας

“the glorious”

Jude is using the adjective **glorious** as a noun to mean a certain kind of being. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this

adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [glorious spiritual beings]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Jude 1:9 (#3)

κρίσιν ἐπενεγκεῖν βλασφημίας

“to bring a judgment of slander {against him”

Jude is using the possessive form to describe a **judgment** that is characterized by **slander**. If this is not clear in your language, you could use a phrase to explain it. Alternate translation: [to bring a slanderous judgment against him]

See: Possession

Jude 1:9 (#2)

κρίσιν ἐπενεγκεῖν βλασφημίας

“to bring a judgment of slander {against him”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **judgment** with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [to accuse him of slander]

See: Abstract Nouns

Jude 1:9 (#1)

κρίσιν ἐπενεγκεῖν βλασφημίας

“to bring a judgment of slander {against him”

Jude speaks of **judgment** as if it were something someone can **bring** from one place to another. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this metaphor plainly. Alternate translation: [to speak a judgment of slander against him]

See: Metaphor

Jude 1:10 (#4)

ἐν τούτοις

“by these things”

Here, **these things** refers back to “what they understand by instinct,” which is sexually immoral acts. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [by these sexually immoral acts]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Jude 1:10 (#1)

οὗτοι

“these ones”

Here, **these ones** refers to the false teachers introduced in verse 4. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this phrase explicitly. Alternate translation: [these false teachers]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Jude 1:10 (#3)

ὅσα δὲ φυσικῶς ὡς τὰ ἄλογα ζῷα ἐπίστανται

“but what they understand by instinct as the unreasoning animals”

This clause refers to the sexual immorality of the false teachers, who thoughtlessly live according to their natural sexual desires the way animals do. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this simile by translating the simile plainly. Alternate translation: [but what they naturally understand, unrestrained sexual desires]

See: Simile

Jude 1:10 (#2)

ὅσα & οὐκ οἶδασιν

“what they do not understand”

This word **what** could refer to: (1) the spiritual realm referred to in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [the spiritual realm, which they do not understand]; (2) the glorious ones mentioned in verse 8. Alternate translation: [the glorious ones, which they do not understand]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Jude 1:10 (#5)

ἐν τούτοις φθείρονται

“by these things they are being destroyed”

If your language does not use the passive form **are being destroyed**, you could express this with an active form. Alternate translation: [these things are destroying them]

See: Active or Passive

Jude 1:11 (#3)

τοῦ Κάιν

“of Cain”

Jude compares the false teachers to **Cain**. Jude assumes that his readers will know that he is referring to a story recorded in the Old Testament book of

Genesis. In that story, Cain made an unacceptable offering to God, and God rejected his offering. As a result he became angry and was jealous of his brother Abel, because God had accepted Abel's offering. Cain's anger and jealousy led him to murder his brother. God punished Cain by banishing him from farming the land. Additionally, at the time Jude wrote this letter, Jews considered Cain to be an example of someone who taught other people how to sin, which is what these false teachers were doing. You could indicate some of this explicitly if it would be helpful to your readers, particularly if they would not know the story. Alternate translation, as a statement: [of Cain, who murdered his brother]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Jude 1:11 (#5)

τοῦ Βαλαὰμ μισθοῦ

“of Balaam {for} wages”

Jude compares the false teachers to **Balaam**. Jude assumes that his readers will know that he is referring to a story recorded in the Old Testament book of Numbers. In that story, Balaam was hired by wicked kings to curse the Israelites. When God did not allow Balaam to do so, Balaam used wicked women to seduce the Israelites into sexual immorality and idol worship so that God would punish them for their disobedience. Balaam did these wicked things because he wanted to be paid by the wicked kings, but he was eventually killed by the Israelites when they conquered the land of Canaan. You could indicate this explicitly if it would be helpful to your readers, particularly if they would not know the story. Alternate translation, as a statement: [of Balaam, who led the Israelites into immorality for money]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Jude 1:11 (#6)

τοῦ Κόρε

“of Korah”

Jude compares the false teachers to **Korah**. Jude assumes that his readers will know that he is referring to a story recorded in the Old Testament book of Numbers. In that story, Korah was a man of Israel who led a rebellion against the leadership of Moses and Aaron, whom God had appointed. God killed Korah and all those who rebelled with him by burning some of them and opening up the ground to swallow up the others. You could indicate some of this explicitly if it would be helpful to your readers, particularly if they

would not know the story. Alternate translation, as a statement: [of Korah, who rebelled against God's appointed leaders,]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Jude 1:11 (#2)

τῇ ὁδῷ τοῦ Κάιν ἐπορεύθησαν

“they have gone in the way of Cain”

Here, **have gone in the way** is a metaphor for “have lived in the same way as.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this metaphor plainly. Alternate translation: [they have lived the same way Cain lived]

See: Metaphor

Jude 1:11 (#1)

οὐαὶ αὐτοῖς

“Woe to them”

The phrase **Woe to them** is the opposite of “blessed are you.” It indicates that bad things are going to happen to the people being addressed, because they have displeased God. Alternate translation: [How terrible it is for them] or [Trouble will come to them]

See: Idiom

Jude 1:11 (#7)

ἀπώλοντο

“they perished”

Jude is using the past tense in order to refer to something that will happen in the future. He is doing this to show that the event will certainly happen. If this is not clear in your language, you could use the future tense. Alternate translation: [they will certainly perish]

See: Predictive Past

Jude 1:11 (#4)

ἐξεχύθησαν

“have abandoned themselves”

Alternate translation: [they have fully committed themselves]

Jude 1:12 (#3)

ταῖς ἀγάπαις

“love feasts”

Here, **love feasts** refers to gatherings of Christians where they ate a meal together. These **feasts** took place in the early church and most likely included sharing the bread and wine to remember the death of Jesus, which Paul calls “the Lord’s Supper” in 1 Corinthians 11:20. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express some of this information explicitly. Alternate translation: [communal meals with fellow believers]

See: Translate Unknowns

Jude 1:12 (#9)

δὲς ἀποθανόντα ἐκριζωθέντα

“**having died twice, having been uprooted**”

Here, **having died twice** could mean: (1) the trees are considered to be dead firstly because they do not produce fruit, but doubly dead because they are uprooted in response to their lack of fruit. Alternate translation: [having died twice by being fruitless and uprooted]; (2) the trees, which represent the false teachers, are spiritually dead but will also be physically dead when God kills them. “being spiritually dead and then physically dead when they were uprooted”

Jude 1:12 (#5)

νεφέλαι ἀνυδροὶ ὑπὸ ἀνέμων παραφερόμεναι

“**waterless clouds, carried along by winds**”

Jude speaks of the false teachers to describe their uselessness. People expect clouds to provide water to grow crops, but **waterless clouds** disappoint farmers by being blown away by the wind without giving rain. In the same way, false teachers, although they promise many things, are unable to do what they promise. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this metaphor by translating this plainly or turn the metaphor into a simile. Alternate translation: [These false teachers never give what they promise] or [These false teachers disappoint like clouds without water]

See: Metaphor

Jude 1:12 (#7)

δένδρα φθινοπωρινὰ ἄκαρπα

“**fruitless autumn trees**”

Here Jude again speaks of the false teachers to describe their uselessness. People expect trees in the autumn to provide fruit, but **fruitless autumn trees** disappoint them. In the same way, false teachers, although they promise many things, are unable to do

what they promise. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this metaphor by translating this plainly or turn the metaphor into a simile. Alternate translation: [never giving what they promise] or [like barren fruit trees]

See: Metaphor

Jude 1:12 (#10)

ἐκριζωθέντα

“**having been uprooted**”

Jude describes God’s judgment of these false teachers like trees that have been completely pulled out of the ground by their roots. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this metaphor plainly. Alternate translation: [having been destroyed]

See: Metaphor

Jude 1:12 (#4)

ἐαυτοὺς ποιμαίνοντες

“**shepherding themselves**”

Here Jude speaks of the false teachers selfishly taking care of their own needs as if they are shepherds who feed and care for themselves instead of their flocks. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this metaphor with a simile or plainly. Alternate translation: [like shepherds that feed themselves instead of their flocks] or [only caring for themselves]

See: Metaphor

Jude 1:12 (#8)

δὲς ἀποθανόντα ἐκριζωθέντα

“**having died twice, having been uprooted**”

Here Jude is using the past tense in order to refer to something that will happen in the future. He is doing this to show that the event will certainly happen. If this is not clear in your language, you could use the future tense. Alternate translation: [they will certainly die twice, they will certainly be uprooted]

See: Predictive Past

Jude 1:12 (#1)

οὗτοί

“**These ones**”

Here, **These ones** refers to the false teachers introduced in verse 4. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this phrase explicitly. Alternate translation: [These false teachers]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Jude 1:12 (#2)

σπιλάδες

“hidden reefs”

Here, **reefs** are large rocks that are very close to the surface of water in the sea. Because sailors cannot see them, they are very dangerous. Ships can easily be destroyed if they hit these rocks. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this metaphor with a simile or plainly. Alternate translation: [they are like hidden reefs] or [although they are inconspicuous, these people are extremely dangerous]

See: Metaphor

Jude 1:12 (#11)

ἐκριζωθέντα

“having been uprooted”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could this with an active form and say who did the action. Alternate translation: [God uprooted them]

See: Active or Passive

Jude 1:12 (#6)

ὑπὸ ἀνέμων παραφερόμεναι

“carried along by winds”

If your language does not use the passive form **carried along**, you could express this with an active form. Alternate translation: [which the wind carries along]

See: Active or Passive

Jude 1:13 (#5)

οἷς

“for whom”

Here, **whom** refers to the false teachers that Jude called “wandering stars” in the previous phrase. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate explicitly that this refers to the false teachers. Alternate translation: [false teachers for whom]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Jude 1:13 (#7)

ὁ ζόφος τοῦ σκότους

“the gloom of darkness”

Here Jude uses **gloom** and **darkness** to refer to hell. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this metaphor directly. Alternate translation: [for whom God has reserved the gloom of darkness of hell]

See: Metaphor

Jude 1:13 (#2)

ἐπαφρίζοντα τὰς ἐαυτῶν αἰσχύνας

“foaming out their own shameful deeds”

Jude expands the wave metaphor of the previous phrase, speaking of the **shameful deeds** of the false teachers. As waves leave dirty foam on the shore that everyone can see, so the false teachers keep on acting shamefully in the sight of others. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this metaphor by translating this plainly or turn the metaphor into a simile. Alternate translation: [they make their shameful deeds visible to everyone] or [they show their shameful deeds like waves leave foam]

See: Metaphor

Jude 1:13 (#4)

οἷς ὁ ζόφος τοῦ σκότους εἰς αἰῶνα τετήρηται

“for whom the gloom of darkness has been kept to eternity”

If your language does not use the passive form **has been kept**, you could express this with an active form, and you can state who did the action. Alternate translation: [for whom God has kept the gloom and darkness to eternity]

See: Active or Passive

Jude 1:13 (#1)

κύματα ἄγρια θαλάσσης

“wild waves of the sea”

Jude speaks of the false teachers to describe their unrestrained and untamable behavior. He describes them as **wild waves** that thrash about in an uncontrollable manner. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this metaphor by translating this plainly or turn the metaphor into a simile. Alternate translation: [they act in an unrestrained manner] or [they are unrestrained like wild waves]

See: Metaphor

Jude 1:13 (#3)

ἀστέρες πλανῆται

“wandering stars”

The phrase **wandering stars** describes **stars** that have wandered away from their normal path of movement. Jude uses this expression to describe the false teachers as people who have stopped doing what pleases the Lord. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this metaphor plainly or with a simile. Alternate translation: [no longer living righteously] or [like stars that wander away from their proper path]

See: Metaphor

Jude 1:13 (#6)

ὁ ζόφος τοῦ σκότους

“the gloom of darkness”

Here, **gloom of darkness** could mean: (1) the gloom is characterized by darkness. Alternate translation: [the dark gloom]; (2) the gloom is identical to the darkness. Alternate translation: [the gloom, which is darkness.]

Jude 1:14 (#1)

ἕβδομος ἀπὸ Ἀδὰμ

“seventh from Adam”

Since **Adam** is considered to be the first generation of mankind, Enoch is the seventh generation.

Jude 1:14 (#7)

μυριάσιν

“myriads”

The word **myriads** is the plural of the Greek word “myriad,” which means ten thousand (10,000) but is often used to refer to a large number. You can express this number in the way that would be most natural in your language. Alternate translation: [tens of thousands]

See: Translate Unknowns

Jude 1:14 (#4)

ἰδοὺ

“Behold”

The term **Behold** focuses the attention of a listener or reader on what a speaker or writer is about to say. Though it literally means “look” or “see,” the term can be used to mean giving notice and attention, and that is how James is using it here. Alternate translation: [Pay attention to what I have to say!]

See: Metaphor

Jude 1:14 (#6)

Κύριος

“The Lord”

Here, **Lord** could refer to: (1) Jesus. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [The Lord Jesus]; (2) God. Alternate translation: [The Lord God]

Jude 1:14 (#8)

ἁγίαις

“holy ones”

Here, **holy ones** could refer to: (1) angels, as suggested by the presence of angels in similar statements about judgment in Matthew 24:31 and 25:31, Mark 8:38, and 2 Thessalonians 1:7. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [his holy angels]; (2) believers. Alternate translation: [his holy believers] or [his saints]

Jude 1:14 (#2)

τούτοις

“about these ones”

Here, **these ones** refers to the false teachers. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [about these false teachers]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Jude 1:14 (#5)

ἦλθεν Κύριος

“The Lord came”

Jude is using the past tense in order to refer to something that will happen in the future. He is doing this to show that the event will certainly happen. If this is not clear in your language, you could use the future tense. Alternate translation: [The Lord will certainly come]

See: Predictive Past

Jude 1:14 (#3)

λέγων

“saying”

Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [and he said]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Jude 1:15 (#6)

αὐτοῦ

“him”

Here the pronoun **him** could refer to: (1) Jesus. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [Jesus]; (2) God. Alternate translation: [God] The option you choose must agree with your choice for the meaning of “Lord” in the previous verse.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Jude 1:15 (#4)

τῶν ἔργων ἀσεβείας αὐτῶν

“their works of ungodliness”

Here Jude is using the possessive form to describe **works** that are characterized by **ungodliness**. If this is not clear in your language, you could use a phrase to explain it. Alternate translation: [ungodly works]

See: Possession

Jude 1:15 (#2)

ποιῆσαι κρίσιν κατὰ

“to do judgment against”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **judgment** with a verbal phrase. Alternate translation: [to judge]

See: Abstract Nouns

Jude 1:15 (#5)

τῶν σκληρῶν

“the harsh things”

Here, **harsh things** refers to harsh statements that sinners speak slanderously against the Lord. Alternate translation: [the harsh words] or [the offensive statements]

Jude 1:15 (#1)

ποιῆσαι κρίσιν & καὶ ἐλέγξει

“to do judgment & and to rebuke”

Both of these instances of the word **to** indicate the purpose for which the Lord comes with his holy ones. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of judgment ... and in order to rebuke]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Jude 1:15 (#3)

πᾶσαν ψυχὴν

“every soul”

Here, **soul** refers to a person. Alternate translation: [every person]

See: Synecdoche

Jude 1:16 (#2)

εἰσιν γογγυσταὶ μεμψίμοιροι

“are murmurers, complainers”

Here the terms **murmurers** and **complainers** refer to two different ways of expressing discontent or unhappiness. While **grumblers** are people who speak their complaints quietly, **complainers** speak them openly. When the Israelites were traveling in the wilderness after leaving Egypt, they were often punished by God for grumbling and complaining against him and their leaders, which is evidently what these false teachers were doing in Jude’s day. Alternate translation: [grumble quietly to themselves and complain loudly]

Jude 1:16 (#1)

οὗτοί

“These ones”

These ones refers to the false teachers that Jude first introduced in verse 4 and has discussed throughout the letter. Since Jude shifted in the previous verse to describing the judgment of everyone who does wicked deeds, it may be helpful for you to inform your readers that this verse returns to specifically focusing on the false teachers. Alternate translation: [These false teachers]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Jude 1:16 (#5)

τὸ στόμα αὐτῶν λαλεῖ

“their mouth speaks”

Here Jude uses the singular **mouth** in a distributive way. If this would be confusing to your readers, you could express this explicitly or use a plural noun and verb. Alternate translation: [the mouth of each of them speaks] or [their mouths speak]

Jude 1:16 (#8)

θαυμάζοντες πρόσωπα

“admiring faces”

This is an idiom that means to show favoritism toward someone or to flatter someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent idiom or use plain language. Alternate translation: [favoring people] or [flattering people]

See: Idiom

Jude 1:16 (#4)

τὰς ἐπιθυμίας αὐτῶν

“their lusts”

Here, **lusts** refers to sinful desires that are opposed to God’s will. Alternate translation: [their sinful desires]

Jude 1:16 (#7)

λαλεῖ ὑπέρογκα

“speaks boastful things”

Here, **boastful things** refers to arrogant statements about themselves that these false teachers were making. Alternate translation: [boasts about themselves] or [speaks boastful statements]

Jude 1:16 (#9)

θαυμάζοντες πρόσωπα

“admiring faces”

Here, **faces** refers to the people they are flattering. Alternate translation: [admiring people]

See: Metonymy

Jude 1:16 (#3)

πορευόμενοι

“going”

Jude uses **going** to refer to habitually doing something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this metaphor literally. Alternate translation: [those habitually living]

See: Metaphor

Jude 1:16 (#6)

τὸ στόμα αὐτῶν λαλεῖ

“their mouth speaks”

Here, **mouth** represents the person who is speaking. Alternate translation: [they speak]

See: Metonymy

Jude 1:17 (#4)

ἡμῶν

“our”

Here, **our** refers to all believers.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Jude 1:17 (#3)

τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν

“of our Lord”

Here, **our Lord** means “the person who is lord over us” or “the person who rules over us.” Alternate translation: [of the person who rules over us]

See: Possession

Jude 1:17 (#1)

ἀγαπητοί

“beloved ones”

Here, **beloved ones** refers to those whom Jude is writing to, which can be extended to all believers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this term explicitly. See how you translated this in verse 3. Alternate translation: [beloved fellow believers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Jude 1:17 (#2)

τῶν ῥημάτων

“the words”

Jude is using **words** to describe the teachings of the apostles that were conveyed by using words. The specific teachings Jude is referring to here are described in the next verse. Alternate translation: [the teachings]

See: Metonymy

Jude 1:18 (#1)

ὅτι ἔλεγον ὑμῖν

“that they said to you”

This phrase indicates that this verse contains the content of the “words” spoken by the apostles, which Jude referred to in the previous verse.

Jude 1:18 (#3)

πορευόμενοι

“going”

Here Jude uses the word **going** to refer to habitually doing something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this metaphor literally. Alternate translation: [those habitually living]

See: Metaphor

Jude 1:18 (#2)

ἐσχάτου χρόνου

“the last time”

Here, **the last time** is an idiom that refers to the time before the return of Jesus. Alternate translation: [the time just before Jesus returns]

See: Idiom

Jude 1:18 (#4)

κατὰ τὰς ἐαυτῶν ἐπιθυμίας & τῶν ἀσεβειῶν

“according to their own lusts of ungodliness”

Here, **lusts of ungodliness** refers to sinful desires that are opposed to God’s will. Alternate translation: [according to their own sinful and ungodly desires]

Jude 1:19 (#4)

ψυχικοί

“soulish”

Jude is using one part of the human being, the soul, as opposed to another part, the spirit, to mean “unspiritual.” The word **soulish** describes someone who lives according to their natural instincts instead of according to God’s word and Spirit. It is used to refer to people who are not true believers. Alternate translation: [unspiritual] or [worldly]

See: Metonymy

Jude 1:19 (#3)

Πνεῦμα

“the Spirit”

Here, **Spirit** refers to the Holy Spirit. It does not refer to the spirit of a human or to an evil spirit. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [the Holy Spirit]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Jude 1:19 (#5)

Πνεῦμα μὴ ἔχοντες

“not having the Spirit”

The Holy **Spirit** is spoken of as if he were something that people can possess. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this metaphor plainly. Alternate translation: [the Spirit is not within them]

See: Metaphor

Jude 1:19 (#2)

οἱ ἀποδιορίζοντες

“the ones causing divisions”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **divisions** with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [the ones dividing others against each other]

See: Abstract Nouns

Jude 1:19 (#1)

οὗτοί

“These”

Here, **These** refers to the mockers Jude referred to in the previous verse. If it would be helpful for your readers, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [These who mock]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Jude 1:20 (#4)

τῇ ἀγιωτάτῃ ὑμῶν πίστει

“in your most holy faith”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **faith** with a verb, such as “trust” or “believe.” Alternate translation: [in what you believe that is most holy]

See: Abstract Nouns

Jude 1:20 (#3)

ἐποικοδομοῦντες ἑαυτοὺς

“building yourselves up”

This clause refers to one means by which Jude’s readers can obey the command to keep themselves in the love of God, which he makes in the next verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could indicate this explicitly. Alternate translation: [by means of building yourselves up]

Jude 1:20 (#2)

ἐποικοδομοῦντες ἑαυτοὺς τῇ ἀγιωτάτῃ ὑμῶν πίστει

“building yourselves up in your most holy faith”

Here Jude speaks of becoming increasingly able to trust in God as if it were the process of constructing a building. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this metaphor plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [causing yourselves to increase]

in trust in God] or [causing yourselves to increase in trust like one builds up a building]

See: Metaphor

Jude 1:20 (#1)

ἀγαπητοί

“beloved ones”

Here, **beloved ones** refers to those to whom Jude is writing, which can be extended to all believers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. See how you translated this in verse 3. Alternate translation: [beloved fellow believers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Jude 1:20 (#5)

ἐν Πνεύματι Ἁγίῳ προσευχόμενοι

“praying in the Holy Spirit”

This clause refers to a second means by which Jude’s readers can obey the command to keep themselves in the love of God, which he makes in the next verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this connection explicitly. Alternate translation: [by means of praying in the Holy Spirit]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Jude 1:21 (#1)

ἐαυτοὺς ἐν ἀγάπῃ Θεοῦ τηρήσατε

“keep yourselves in the love of God”

If your language would put the command at the front of the sentence and before other modifying clauses, then you could create a verse bridge by moving this clause to the previous verse, placing it just before “building yourselves up in your most holy faith”. You would need to present the combined verses as 20–21.

See: Verse Bridges

Jude 1:21 (#6)

ἡμῶν

“our”

Here, **our** refers to all believers.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Jude 1:21 (#5)

τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν

“of our Lord”

Here, **our Lord** means “the person who is lord over us” or “the person who rules over us.” See how you translated this expression in verse 17. Alternate translation: [of the person who rules over us,]

See: Possession

Jude 1:21 (#4)

τὸ ἔλεος τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ

“the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ”

Here, **mercy** could refer to: (1) the mercy Jesus will show to believers when he returns to earth. Alternate translation: [our Lord Jesus Christ to return and act mercifully]; (2) Jesus’ continued acts of mercy toward believers in general. Alternate translation: [our Lord Jesus Christ to act mercifully]

See: Abstract Nouns

Jude 1:21 (#7)

τὸ ἔλεος τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ, εἰς ζωὴν αἰώνιον

“the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ to eternal life”

Jude is using **to** to introduce the result of **the mercy**. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ, which brings eternal life]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Jude 1:21 (#3)

προσδεχόμενοι τὸ ἔλεος τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν

“waiting for the mercy of our Lord”

This clause occurs at the same time as the clause that precedes it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this connection explicitly. Alternate translation: [while waiting for the mercy of our Lord] or [while expecting the mercy of our Lord]

See: Connect — Simultaneous Time Relationship

Jude 1:21 (#2)

ἐαυτοὺς ἐν ἀγάπῃ Θεοῦ τηρήσατε

“keep yourselves in the love of God”

Jude speaks of remaining able to receive the **love of God** as if one were keeping oneself in a certain place. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this metaphor explicitly. Alternate translation: [keep yourselves able to receive the love of God]

See: Metaphor

Jude 1:22 (#1)

ἐλεᾶτε

“have mercy on”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **mercy** with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [act mercifully toward]

See: Abstract Nouns

Jude 1:22 (#2)

οὓς & διακρινόμενους

“some} who are doubting”

The phrase **{some} who are doubting** refers to people who have become confused because of the teaching and activities of the false teachers. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [some who are uncertain about what to believe]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Jude 1:23 (#1)

ἐκ πυρὸς ἁρπάζοντες

“snatching from fire”

This clause indicates the means by which Jude wants his audience to save a certain group of people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this connection explicitly. Alternate translation: [by means of snatching from fire]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Jude 1:23 (#5)

τῆς σαρκὸς

“the flesh”

Here, **flesh** is used to refer to a person’s sinful nature. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this metaphor literally. Alternate translation: [their sinful nature]

See: Metaphor

Jude 1:23 (#2)

ἐκ πυρὸς ἁρπάζοντες

“snatching from fire”

Jude speaks of urgently rescuing some people from going to hell as though it was like pulling people from a **fire** before they start to burn. If it would be helpful in

your language, you could state this metaphor plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [doing whatever must be done to keep them from going to hell] or [doing whatever must be done to save them, as if pulling them from fire]

See: Metaphor

Jude 1:23 (#3)

ἐλεᾶτε

“have mercy on”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **mercy** with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [act mercifully toward]

See: Abstract Nouns

Jude 1:23 (#4)

μισοῦντες καὶ τὸν ἀπὸ τῆς σαρκὸς ἐσπιλωμένον χιτῶνα

“hating even the garment having been defiled by the flesh”

Jude exaggerates to warn his readers that they can become like those sinners. Alternate translation: [treating them as though you could become guilty of sin just by touching their clothes]

See: Hyperbole

Jude 1:24 (#3)

τῆς δόξης αὐτοῦ

“his glory”

Here, **glory** refers to the bright light that surrounds the presence of God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this abstract noun by translating it with an adjective. Alternate translation: [his glorious presence]

See: Abstract Nouns

Jude 1:24 (#1)

τῷ δὲ δυναμένῳ φυλάττειν

“Now to the one being able to keep”

Here, **the one** refers to God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to God, who is able to keep]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Jude 1:24 (#2)

φυλάξαι ὑμᾶς ἀπταιστούς

“to keep you without stumbling”

Jude uses **stumbling** to speak of returning to habitual sin as if one is tripping over something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this metaphor plainly. Alternate translation: [to prevent you from returning to sinful habits]

See: Metaphor

Jude 1:24 (#4)

ἐν ἀγαλλιάσει

“in exultation”

This phrase describes the manner in which believers will stand before God. Alternate translation: [joyfully]

Jude 1:25 (#1)

μόνῳ Θεῷ Σωτῆρι ἡμῶν

“to the only God our Savior”

Here, **our Savior** refers to God. It does not refer to Jesus. This phrase emphasizes that God the Father, as well as the Son, is the Savior. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this phrase explicitly. Alternate translation: [to the only God, who is our Savior]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Jude 1:25 (#6)

εἰς πάντας τοὺς αἰῶνας

“to all eternity”

This is an idiom that means “forever.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent idiom or use plain language. Alternate translation: [to eternity] or [forever]

See: Idiom

Jude 1:25 (#2)

Σωτῆρι ἡμῶν

“our Savior”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **Savior** with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [the person who saves]

See: Abstract Nouns

Jude 1:25 (#4)

μόνῳ Θεῷ & δόξα, μεγαλωσύνη, κράτος, καὶ ἐξουσία

“to the only God & be} glory, majesty, power, and authority”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the abstract nouns **glory, majesty, power** and **authority** by translating them with adjective phrases. Alternate translation: [may the only God ... be recognized as glorious, majestic, powerful, and authoritative]

See: Abstract Nouns

Jude 1:25 (#3)

τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν

“our Lord”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **Lord** with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [the person who rules]

See: Abstract Nouns

Jude 1:25 (#5)

πρὸ παντὸς τοῦ αἰῶνος

“before all the age”

This is an idiom that refers to eternity past. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent idiom or use plain language. Alternate translation: [in eternity past] or [before everything]

See: Idiom